

ALEXANDER BERECK

alexander@zinaeva.com
New York, New York
cocoon360.github.io/portfoliosite

Early-career developer and researcher with experience in user behavior analysis, AI-assisted prototyping, growth strategy, and interactive systems. Strong at turning abstract information into clear frameworks, prototypes, and usable workflows across product, research, and development.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Bird Brain, Product Developer — April 2026 - Present

- Built a local-first AI tool that turns messy project folders into interactive hypertext concept maps.
- Created for organizing Birdsong's research/design archive, with a reusable engine that can map and synthesize any text or code project folder.

Birdsong, Video Game Designer and Developer — November 2025 - Present

- Building a 12-20 hour 3D narrative-driven mystery adventure in Unity from concept to implementation, owning systems design, narrative logic, and iterative development workflows.
- Designing branching mechanics, investigation systems, and interaction structures that respond to player choice while staying coherent across technical and production constraints.
- Using AI-assisted workflows to prototype ideas, structure systems, and accelerate writing.
- Managing a long-horizon independent project across design, implementation, research, and documentation, while building an authentic early-2010s setting through cultural research, dialogue, and environmental storytelling.

BePresent, Product and Game Designer — September - November 2025

- Designed three modular gamification systems for a screen-time wellness app, including progression loops, activity structures, and AI-prompted personalization concepts.
- Built frameworks connecting individual progress to shared motivation, helping translate product ideas into clearer systems and user flows.
- Rapidly prototyped and iterated concepts for user-generated content and rejection therapy inspired activity systems in Figma and Cursor for stakeholder review and decision-making.

222place, Ethnographic Researcher and Growth Strategist — July - October 2025

- Conducted ethnographic research across 60+ live events to identify patterns in user behavior, engagement, and product-market fit.
- Synthesized behavioral patterns and growth signals into reusable frameworks that informed product and growth decision making.
- Supported launch in 4 global cities, managing 50+ creator partnerships and contributing to expansion that doubled the platform's market footprint.

EDUCATION

B.A. in English, and Mandarin, Fordham University, New York, New York - Spring 2025

SKILLS

- | | | |
|--------------------------|-------------|-----------------------------|
| • Ethnographic Research | • Figma | • Photogrammetry |
| • User Behavior Analysis | • Unity | • Cursor and MCP tools |
| • Interaction Design | • Blender | • Git version control |
| • Rapid Prototyping | • Photoshop | • TypeScript and JavaScript |